

TRANSFORMING AFRICA: A VISION THROUGH YOUTH-DRIVEN TECHNOLOGY & ETHICAL LEADERSHIP

Johann Wolfgang von Goethe once said “Life belongs to the living, and those who truly live must be ready to embrace change”, These words fuel my mission to make Africa's future belong to the youth, the problem solvers. Despite Africa’s rich resources it struggles to reach its full potential due to various challenges, including corruption and poor leadership. But Africa’s youth has the potential to transform Africa, with their ability to think critically, the technical environment and the growing impact of artificial intelligence to drive change. Africa now stands a chance to become a more dependable future focused on real progress and consistent development.

Firstly, Africa’s youth are ready to lead by addressing areas in education, healthcare and infrastructure to empower citizens and bring about development. My eye-opener was when a relative of mine was rushed to the hospital. His file could not be found. My hands shook as I watched the nurses scramble. How could a hospital lose a patient file in 2023? This sparked my mission to harness technology for the healthcare revolution.

As a youth, I am committed to contributing to Africa's journey towards a thriving continent. I developed a feature in my school’s portal for students to access internal past questions. This was an experience that improved my ability to think critically and solve problems. The sleepless nights spent debugging showed me that technology can do more than solve academic issues, it could help those in rural areas. I have witnessed the harm caused by the poor health system and I am done waiting for change. I want to build it. I may be young but every line of code I learn brings me closer to my dream of becoming a software engineer using artificial intelligence to transform health across Africa.

Ashesi represents the ideal environment for me to realize my ambitions. Ashesi's emphasis on ethical leadership, innovation, and academic excellence perfectly aligns with my values and goals. At Ashesi, I will not just learn coding or business but I will turn ideas into action. The institution's honour code which is premised on integrity resonates with my values as a student and an upcoming leader. My mission is not just about personal growth but also about helping others through technology driven innovation. I aim to take the skills I will gain at Ashesi and develop technology which would make education and healthcare more accessible especially to less deprived communities.

Transforming Africa requires bold and ethical leaders as well as critical thinkers. With the education I will receive at Ashesi, I am confident I would gain the ability to meet this challenge, and be the change maker transforming Africa. Having coded the portal feature which allows students to access past questions, taught me that progress is messy, but Africa's problems would not fix themselves. I know the road ahead will not be easy, but I am ready to code, lead and guide, one at a time.